

TAB 32



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-022-25/26, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 10/14/2025**In Control:** Board of Education

Ms. Ortiz Franklin, Ms. Newbill, Ms. Griego - With Survivors, Always: Domestic & Dating Violence Prevention, Awareness and Support (Res-022-25/26) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District prioritizes the safety of all students, staff and families and is committed to violence prevention, harm reduction, whole-child wellbeing, employee wellness, systems change and restorative justice at school and in the community;

Whereas, October is annually recognized as National Domestic Violence Awareness Month; and although progress has been made toward ending generational cycles of violence and providing support to survivors and their families, 35% of women and 31% of men in California experience domestic violence and it remains a leading cause of homelessness for children and women;

Whereas, 1 in 3 adolescents in America are victims of teen dating violence, which involves sexual, physical, verbal, cyber or emotional abuse and only 33% of teens in an abusive relationship ever reported the abuse; 81% of parents believe teen dating violence is not an issue or report they do not know it is an issue; and teens who experience dating abuse are at risk for long-term consequences including addiction, eating disorders, teen pregnancy, sexually transmitted infections, violent behavior and thoughts of suicide, including 50% of young people who experience rape, physical or sexual abuse attempting suicide;

Whereas, Adverse Childhood Experiences (ACES) such as exposure to domestic violence increase the risk for long-term consequences, including difficulty at school, substance abuse, behavioral problems in adolescence, and serious physical and mental health problems as adults;

Whereas, Domestic violence affects people of all genders, sexual orientations, ages, abilities and disabilities, and racial, ethnic, cultural, social, religious, and economic groups in the United States, it has a disproportionate impact on LGBTQIA+, immigrants, undocumented individuals, and Black, Native and Latine Americans;

Whereas, Domestic violence can be influenced by economic instability, gender and cultural norms, patriarchal culture and other environmental and societal elements including film, video games, social and mainstream media, and public figures; and domestic and dating violence are often an effect of intergenerational trauma within the systems of heteropatriarchy, capitalism, and colonialism that promote a culture of control, domination, fear, shame, and lack of accountability;

Whereas, Building the capacity of communities and schools to intervene, interrupt, and transform systems and culture through educational programs, healing, and practicing transformative justice are key to addressing domestic and dating violence;

Whereas, Since 1990, the Clothesline Project has used decorated shirts hung on a clothesline as a

powerful visual display to raise awareness about the often-silenced experiences of violence against women, providing survivors, families, and supporters a meaningful and healing way to share their stories; and with over 500 projects in 41 states and 5 countries, it continues to educate, empower, and foster compassionate, supportive communities worldwide;

Whereas, In September 2020, the State of California was one of the first in the nation to recognize “coercive control” as a form of domestic violence; that is, even if violence is not visible, if it is a “pattern of behavior that unreasonably interferes with a person’s free will and personal liberty” it is recognized as unlawful and validating for many victims/survivors;

Whereas, Recent California State legislation includes AB 2053 requiring comprehensive sexual health education to include resources related to adolescent relationship abuse and intimate partner violence and AB1071 requiring the publication of information on dating violence prevention on the California Department of Education’s website;

Whereas, Domestic and dating violence is underreported for fears of retaliation, financial dependence, immigration status, loss of trust in people and systems, in addition to deeply personal and complex concerns, and all victims/survivors and communities deserve access to culturally responsive prevention programs and services to increase community safety and individual wellbeing;

Whereas, Recognizing the expertise across Los Angeles, the District has partnered with various organizations and educators to teach healthy relationships and violence prevention in schools as a part of the California Health Standards, especially in grades 7 and 9; and

Whereas, To truly support the District’s Strategic Plan pillars of Academic Excellence, Joy and Wellness, Engagement and Collaboration, and Investing in Staff, the District must promote more awareness, education, and support to prevent and eventually end all forms of violence, including domestic, dating and intimate partner violence; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District recognizes October 2025, and each following October, as Domestic Violence Awareness Month and supports survivors, victims, and witnesses of domestic, dating and intimate partner violence, defined as a pattern of abusive behavior in a relationship that is used by one partner to gain or maintain power and control over another intimate partner, including physical, sexual, emotional, economic, psychological, technological or digital actions or threats of actions or other patterns of coercive behavior that influence another person, such as behaviors that intimidate, manipulate, humiliate, isolate, frighten, terrorize, coerce, threaten, blame, hurt, injure, or wound someone;

Resolved further, That the Board recognizes the key role of educators, school staff, families, mental health professionals, government and community partners in building the capacities of our school community to prevent, address, and reduce the negative effects of the harms of domestic and dating violence, including cultivating the protective factors of safer and more stable conditions, social connections, resilience and growth mindset, nurturing parent-child interactions, and social and emotional abilities;

Resolved further, That the Superintendent will deepen education and supports for students, staff, parents and families on healthy relationships and teen dating violence prevention through the following steps:

- Embed the topic of domestic and dating violence in at least one relevant Every School Safe (or similar) module, which is a series of monthly trainings for staff, workshops for families and assemblies for students on the awareness and prevention of safety concerns such as suicide, substance use, child abuse, and cyber security;
- Deepen and improve upon direct instruction on healthy relationships informed through student input;
- Consider additional professional development opportunities for school staff, including and not limited to psychiatric social workers, counselors, nurses and psychologists;
- Create at least one session for the Family Academy to help parents and families recognize the signs of domestic and teen dating violence and know where to access support, including financial, legal, employment, housing, and physical and mental health;
- Promote resources, including opportunities for safe anonymous reporting, such as those of the National Domestic Violence Hotline at 800-799-7233 or texting “start” to 88788 and loveisrespect.org <<http://loveisrespect.org>>, where youth ages 13 - 26 can text “loveis” to 22522 or call 866-331-9474 for support, the Domestic Violence Awareness Project at [dvawareness.org](http://www.dvawareness.org) <<http://www.dvawareness.org>>; and the LA County Office of Violence Prevention’s Domestic Violence Toolkit, available February 2026;
- Assess and build upon student-led efforts like school clubs, events, peer support and social media campaigns;
- Consider and act upon strategies to ensure confidentiality, sensitivity and protections for parents and families experiencing, escaping and/or healing from domestic violence; and
- Spread awareness of the Domestic Violence Awareness 2025 theme “With Survivors, Always | Con Sobrevivientes. Siempre,” and the social media campaigns #WithSurvivors #DVAM2025 and #PurpleThursday, a National Day of Action to raise awareness by wearing purple on Thursday, October 23, 2025 and every year on the Thursday of the third full week in October to start conversations and end the silence around domestic violence;

Resolved further, That the Superintendent will strengthen supports for employees, including: continued training for supervisors and employees on entitled leave for victims and survivors, confidentiality, potential accommodations or temporary flexible work schedules; and offering referrals for mental health, housing, legal and financial support, including resources such as the California Victim Compensation Board;

Resolved further, That the Superintendent will cultivate intentional partnerships with experts specializing in culturally responsive domestic and dating violence through steps that may include:

- Creating a central list of current no cost Memorandums of Understanding (MOUs) detailing services, schools receiving services, and capacity to serve other schools if interested;
- Promoting widespread awareness of steps to partner with the District through the MOU process by updating guidance documents and hosting informational sessions like that of a partner forum; and
- Reviewing and updating pertinent bulletins, guidance and other resource documents related to no-cost health, non-health and mental health service MOUs;

Resolved further, That the Board directs the Office of Government Relations to consider domestic and dating violence, as well as opportunities to improve the victim, survivor and youth witness experience with government institutions, including city, county, judicial and publicly-funded nonprofit services, as

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a safety topic of importance for the 2026-27 Advocacy Guiding Principles and Priorities and subsequent years as is needed; and be it finally

Resolved, That the Superintendent will provide a written update to the Board on such efforts, including potential budget impacts, by February 2026, which is observed nationally and will be observed each February in LA Unified as Teen Dating Violence Awareness Month.